



Salesforce Administrator — Complete Interview Preparation Guide

Theory + Implementation + Ready-to-speak Interview Answers

Har topic ke saath: Definition • Implementation Steps • Ready-to-speak Interview Answer

Good luck for your interview! ■

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1. Salesforce & Cloud Computing Basics

What is Salesforce?

DEFINITION

Salesforce is a cloud-based CRM (Customer Relationship Management) platform delivered as SaaS (Software as a Service). It runs on multi-tenant architecture, meaning many customers (orgs) share the same infrastructure and codebase but their data is logically isolated and secure.

HOW TO IMPLEMENT (Setup steps)

Salesforce is accessed entirely through a browser or mobile app — no installation needed. Core clouds: Sales Cloud, Service Cloud, Marketing Cloud, Experience Cloud, Platform (Force.com).

INTERVIEW-READY ANSWER

"Salesforce is a cloud-based CRM platform built on a multi-tenant SaaS architecture. It lets businesses manage sales, service, and customer data from a single system, and it's highly customizable using declarative tools like Flow, and programmatic tools like Apex, without needing on-premise servers."

SaaS vs PaaS vs IaaS

DEFINITION

IaaS gives raw infrastructure (servers, storage) — e.g. AWS EC2. PaaS gives a platform to build apps without managing infrastructure — e.g. Force.com/Heroku. SaaS delivers ready-to-use software over the internet — e.g. Salesforce Sales Cloud.

HOW TO IMPLEMENT (Setup steps)

Salesforce itself is SaaS for end users, but the underlying Force.com platform (used to build custom objects, Apex, Flows) is PaaS.

INTERVIEW-READY ANSWER

"Salesforce is both — as a CRM product it's SaaS, and the underlying Force.com platform that lets admins/developers build custom apps on top of it is PaaS."

Multi-tenant Architecture

DEFINITION

A single application instance and database structure serves multiple customers (tenants), with each tenant's data logically separated using an OrgID, while all tenants share the same core infrastructure and get automatic upgrades.

HOW TO IMPLEMENT (Setup steps)

Every record in Salesforce is tagged internally with an OrgID so queries only ever return data belonging to that org, even though physical storage is shared.

INTERVIEW-READY ANSWER

"Multi-tenancy means multiple companies use the same Salesforce infrastructure and codebase, but their data is completely isolated. This is why Salesforce can push three seasonal releases a year to everyone at once, and why it's so cost-efficient for customers."

2. Data Model — Objects, Fields & Relationships

Standard vs Custom Objects

DEFINITION

Standard Objects are pre-built by Salesforce (Account, Contact, Lead, Opportunity, Case). Custom Objects are created by admins to store business-specific data and always carry the suffix __c (e.g. Project__c).

HOW TO IMPLEMENT (Setup steps)

Setup → Object Manager → Create → Custom Object. Define label, plural label, record name (auto-number or text), enable features like Reports, Activities, Track Field History, Allow Search, and Allow Sharing.

INTERVIEW-READY ANSWER

"Standard objects come out-of-the-box for common CRM entities like Account and Opportunity. When the business has a unique data need — say tracking 'Projects' or 'Assets under warranty' — I'd create a Custom Object, ending in __c, and add the fields, relationships, and page layout it needs."

Field Types (key ones)

DEFINITION

Text, Number, Currency, Date/Date-Time, Checkbox, Picklist, Multi-Select Picklist, Formula, Roll-Up Summary, Lookup Relationship, Master-Detail Relationship, Auto Number, Email, Phone, Text Area (Long/Rich).

HOW TO IMPLEMENT (Setup steps)

Object Manager → Fields & Relationships → New. Choose data type, set field-level security per profile, add to page layouts.

INTERVIEW-READY ANSWER

"I pick the field type based on the data and reporting need — Picklist for a fixed set of values that need clean reporting, Formula for auto-calculated read-only values, and Roll-Up Summary when I need to aggregate child records onto a parent — but that only works on Master-Detail relationships."

Lookup vs Master-Detail Relationship

DEFINITION

Lookup: loosely couples two objects; child can exist without a parent; deleting parent does not delete child (unless a delete-cascade is configured); no automatic sharing/rollup. Master-Detail: tightly couples objects; child cannot exist without parent; deleting parent deletes all children (cascade delete); child inherits parent's sharing & security; enables Roll-Up Summary fields; the detail record's owner is tied to the master.

HOW TO IMPLEMENT (Setup steps)

Create field → choose 'Lookup Relationship' or 'Master-Detail Relationship' → select parent object → for Master-Detail, decide sharing setting and whether to allow reparenting later.

INTERVIEW-READY ANSWER

"A Lookup is a loose link — for example, an Opportunity looking up to a Campaign — the two can exist independently. A Master-Detail is a tight parent-child bond — like Opportunity Line Items under an Opportunity — where the child has no security of its own, inherits the parent's sharing, and is deleted automatically if the parent is deleted. I also use Master-Detail whenever I need Roll-Up Summary fields."

Many-to-Many Relationship (Junction Object)

DEFINITION

Salesforce doesn't support direct many-to-many; it's built using a Junction Object that has two Master-Detail (or Lookup) relationships to the two objects being connected.

HOW TO IMPLEMENT (Setup steps)

Example: connecting Students and Courses — create a junction object 'Enrollment__c' with two Master-Detail fields: Student__c and Course__c.

INTERVIEW READY ANSWER

"Since Salesforce only supports one-to-many natively, for a many-to-many I create a junction object with two master-detail relationships — like an 'Enrollment' object linking Students and Courses — so one student can have many courses and vice versa."

Schema Builder / Object Relationship Overview

DEFINITION

A visual, drag-and-drop tool to view and build objects, fields, and relationships across the org.

HOW TO IMPLEMENT (Setup steps)

Setup → Schema Builder. Select objects to visualize; can create new objects/fields directly on the canvas.

INTERVIEW READY ANSWER

"I use Schema Builder mainly to visually explain the data model to stakeholders or to quickly sanity-check relationships before building automation on top of them."

3. Security Model

Organization-Wide Defaults (OWD)

DEFINITION

The baseline, most restrictive level of record access for an object across the org. Options: Private, Public Read Only, Public Read/Write (and Controlled by Parent for detail/child objects).

HOW TO IMPLEMENT (Setup steps)

Setup → Sharing Settings → select object → Edit → set default internal (and external) access.

INTERVIEW/DEADLY ANSWER

"OWD sets the floor of access — the most restrictive setting. If Opportunities are set to Private, nobody sees another user's opportunity unless access is opened up through role hierarchy, sharing rules, or manual sharing. I always start restrictive and open up access deliberately, rather than the other way round."

Role Hierarchy

DEFINITION

Defines vertical access — records owned by, or shared with, a user are automatically visible to that user's superiors in the role hierarchy (unless 'Grant Access Using Hierarchies' is unchecked, which is only possible for custom objects).

HOW TO IMPLEMENT (Setup steps)

Setup → Roles → build a tree (e.g. CEO → Sales Manager → Sales Rep). Assign each user a Role on their user record.

INTERVIEW/DEADLY ANSWER

"Role hierarchy gives managers automatic visibility into their subordinates' records — a Sales Manager can see every deal owned by reps under them, without needing an explicit sharing rule."

Sharing Rules

DEFINITION

Automatic exceptions to OWD that open up access horizontally — e.g., to a public group, role, or role-and-subordinates — based on record ownership or a criteria/field value.

HOW TO IMPLEMENT (Setup steps)

Setup → Sharing Settings → object → New Sharing Rule. Choose Owner-based or Criteria-based, source group/role, target group/role, and access level (Read Only / Read-Write).

INTERVIEW/DEADLY ANSWER

"Sharing rules extend access beyond OWD without changing the baseline. For example, if OWD on Cases is Private, I could add a criteria-based sharing rule so all Cases with Priority = 'High' become Read/Write for the entire Support team public group."

Profiles vs Permission Sets vs Permission Set Groups

DEFINITION

Profile: mandatory, one per user, controls baseline object/field permissions, page layouts, apps, tabs, login hours/IP. Permission Set: optional, additive, grants extra permissions without changing the profile, a user can have many. Permission Set Group: bundles multiple permission sets into one assignable unit.

HOW TO IMPLEMENT (Setup steps)

Setup → Profiles (edit object/field/system permissions) and Setup → Permission Sets → New → assign object, field, app, and system permissions → assign to users.

INTERVIEW READY ANSWER

"I follow the principle of least privilege — give a minimal, cloned profile per role, then layer on Permission Sets for exceptions, like giving one rep temporary access to Delete on Opportunities. This is more scalable than maintaining dozens of near-duplicate profiles."

Field-Level Security (FLS)

DEFINITION

Controls whether a field is Visible, Read-Only, or Hidden for a given profile or permission set, independent of the page layout.

HOW TO IMPLEMENT (Setup steps)

Object Manager → Fields & Relationships → field → Set Field-Level Security, or manage via Profile/Permission Set → Object Settings.

INTERVIEW READY ANSWER

"Page layout controls where a field appears; field-level security controls who can actually see or edit it — a field can be on the layout but still hidden per-profile through FLS, e.g. hiding SSN from everyone except HR."

Record Types & Page Layouts

DEFINITION

Record Types let one object support different picklist value sets and business processes for different users (e.g., 'Enterprise Lead' vs 'SMB Lead'). Page Layouts control which fields, related lists, and buttons appear on a record's detail/edit page, and can be assigned per profile & record type.

HOW TO IMPLEMENT (Setup steps)

Object Manager → Record Types → New → select picklist values available; Object Manager → Page Layouts → design layout → Page Layout Assignment matrix maps Profile x Record Type to a layout.

INTERVIEW READY ANSWER

"Record Types drive different sales processes and picklist values for different segments on the same object, and I pair them with Page Layout assignments so, say, an Enterprise Lead layout shows different fields than an SMB Lead layout, all on the standard Lead object."

4. Automation Tools

Flow (Screen Flow / Record-Triggered / Autolaunched / Scheduled)

DEFINITION

Salesforce's primary no-code automation tool. Screen Flow: guided, interactive UI for users. Record-Triggered Flow: fires before/after a record is created/updated/deleted. Autolaunched Flow: runs in background, invoked by Apex/Process/other flows. Scheduled Flow: runs on a batch schedule.

HOW TO IMPLEMENT (Setup steps)

Setup → Flows → New Flow → choose type → build with Elements (Get/Create/Update/Delete Records, Decision, Loop, Assignment) → Activate.

INTERVIEW-READY ANSWER

"Flow is now Salesforce's recommended automation tool since Workflow Rules and Process Builder are being retired. I use Record-Triggered Flows for backend automation like field updates and record creation, and Screen Flows when I need to guide a user through data entry, like a guided case-closure wizard."

Workflow Rules & Process Builder (Legacy)

DEFINITION

Workflow Rules: old, simple automation — field updates, email alerts, tasks, outbound messages, single-object only. Process Builder: more powerful, visual, multi-object, could invoke sub-processes and Flows. Both are officially retired/legacy — Salesforce now pushes everything into Flow.

HOW TO IMPLEMENT (Setup steps)

Still viewable under Setup → Workflow Rules / Process Builder, but Salesforce recommends migrating them to Flow using the built-in Migrate to Flow tool.

INTERVIEW-READY ANSWER

"I know Workflow Rules and Process Builder well since a lot of orgs still run on them, but for anything new I build in Flow — it's more powerful and it's where Salesforce's roadmap is headed, since Workflow Rules and Process Builder are being sunset."

Approval Process

DEFINITION

A formal, multi-step process to route a record for approval/rejection, with defined approvers, actions on approve/reject/recall, and optional locking of records during approval.

HOW TO IMPLEMENT (Setup steps)

Setup → Approval Processes → New → define entry criteria, approver (user, queue, or manager), initial submission actions, final approval/rejection actions.

INTERVIEW-READY ANSWER

"I'd use an Approval Process for anything needing a formal sign-off with an audit trail — for example, a discount above 20% on an Opportunity needs my manager's approval before the deal can be closed; I'd lock the record during approval so no one edits it mid-review."

Validation Rules

DEFINITION

Declarative rules that prevent a record from being saved unless the specified formula/condition evaluates to TRUE-safe (i.e. the rule fires — blocks the save — when the formula returns TRUE and shows an error).

HOW TO IMPLEMENT (Setup steps)

Object Manager → Validation Rules → New → write the formula (e.g. `AND(ISPICKVAL(Stage,"Closed Won"), Amount < 1000)`) → set the Error Message and where it displays.

INTERVIEW-READY ANSWER

"Validation rules enforce data quality at save time. For instance, I'd stop a rep from marking an Opportunity 'Closed Won' if the Amount field is blank, using a rule like `ISBLANK(Amount)` combined with the stage check, with a clear inline error message telling them exactly what to fix."

Formula Fields vs Roll-Up Summary Fields

DEFINITION

Formula Field: read-only calculated field on the same object, or referencing fields up the Master-Detail chain, recalculated on the fly. Roll-Up Summary Field: on the master side of a Master-Detail relationship, aggregates (SUM, COUNT, MIN, MAX) values from child records.

HOW TO IMPLEMENT (Setup steps)

Object Manager → Fields & Relationships → New → Formula (choose return type + build formula) or Roll-Up Summary (choose summarized object, field, and filter criteria).

INTERVIEW-READY ANSWER

*"Formula fields calculate a value using fields on the record itself — like $Total = Price * Quantity$. Roll-Up Summary fields pull an aggregate from child records up to the parent, but that only works across a Master-Detail relationship — like totaling all Opportunity Line Item amounts onto the Opportunity."*

5. Data Management

Data Import Wizard vs Data Loader

DEFINITION

Data Import Wizard: browser-based, simple UI, supports Accounts, Contacts, Leads, Custom Objects; limit ~50,000 records per import; supports duplicate handling. Data Loader: standalone desktop client (or CLI), supports ALL standard/custom objects, up to 5 million records, supports insert/update/upsert/delete/hard delete/export, and can be scheduled.

HOW TO IMPLEMENT (Setup steps)

Import Wizard: Setup → Data Import Wizard. Data Loader: download from Setup → Data Loader → map CSV columns to fields → choose operation.

INTERVIEW-READY ANSWER

"For a quick one-time load of a few thousand Leads with a friendly UI, I'd use the Data Import Wizard. For large volume loads, upserts using an External ID, or any object not supported by the wizard, I'd use Data Loader — it also lets me do hard deletes and bulk exports."

Duplicate Rules & Matching Rules

DEFINITION

Matching Rule: defines the logic (exact/fuzzy) to identify potential duplicate records. Duplicate Rule: defines what happens when a match is found — Block or Allow (with alert), applies at record save or via a report.

HOW TO IMPLEMENT (Setup steps)

Setup → Duplicate Rules / Matching Rules → New → select fields, matching criteria (exact/fuzzy), and action (Block/Alert, Report).

INTERVIEW-READY ANSWER

"I set up a Matching Rule on, say, Email + Company for Leads, then a Duplicate Rule that blocks the save and shows an alert if a match is found — that keeps the sales team from creating duplicate Leads while still letting them see and merge if needed."

Mass Transfer, Mass Delete & Data Export

DEFINITION

Mass Transfer: reassigns ownership of many records at once (e.g., when a rep leaves). Mass Delete: bulk-deletes records via Setup UI for select standard objects. Data Export Service: exports a full or incremental backup of org data as CSV, schedulable weekly/monthly on eligible editions.

HOW TO IMPLEMENT (Setup steps)

Setup → Mass Transfer Records / Mass Delete Records / Data Export.

INTERVIEW-READY ANSWER

"When a rep leaves the company, I'd use Mass Transfer Records to reassign all their open Leads and Opportunities to their manager or replacement in one action instead of editing records one by one."

6. Reports & Dashboards

Report Types

DEFINITION

Standard: pre-built by Salesforce for standard/custom object relationships. Custom Report Type (CRT): admin-defined, lets you join up to 4 related objects and choose which fields are report-eligible.

HOW TO IMPLEMENT (Setup steps)

Setup → Report Types → New Custom Report Type → choose primary object, related object (with A-B / with-or-without relationship), select fields available for reports.

INTERVIEW-READY ANSWER

"If I need to report across objects that don't have an out-of-the-box report type — like Accounts with their related Cases and Contacts together — I'd build a Custom Report Type joining those objects so users can pull that combined data into a report."

Report Formats

DEFINITION

Tabular: simple list, no grouping (can't be used in a dashboard directly). Summary: grouped rows with subtotals.

Matrix: grouped by rows AND columns, good for cross-tab analysis.

HOW TO IMPLEMENT (Setup steps)

Report Builder → choose format from the dropdown when creating/editing a report.

INTERVIEW-READY ANSWER

"I'd use Tabular for a simple record list or export, Summary when I need subtotals grouped by, say, Stage, and Matrix when I want to cross-tab two dimensions at once — like Opportunity Amount by both Sales Rep and Month."

Dashboards & Dynamic Dashboards

DEFINITION

A dashboard is a visual (charts, gauges, tables) representation of one or more reports. A Dynamic Dashboard runs as the logged-in user, so each viewer sees only the data they have access to; a standard dashboard runs as one fixed 'Running User'.

HOW TO IMPLEMENT (Setup steps)

Setup → Dashboards → New Dashboard → add components sourced from reports → set 'View dashboard as' to a fixed user or 'Run as logged-in user' for dynamic dashboards.

INTERVIEW-READY ANSWER

"For an executive dashboard I'd run it as a fixed user so everyone sees the same company-wide numbers. But for a dashboard shared across the whole sales team where each rep should only see their own deals, I'd make it a Dynamic Dashboard so it respects each viewer's own record access."

7. Sales Cloud & Service Cloud Essentials

Lead → Opportunity Conversion

DEFINITION

Converting a qualified Lead creates/updates an Account, Contact, and (optionally) an Opportunity, carrying over mapped field data.

HOW TO IMPLEMENT (Setup steps)

Lead record → 'Convert' button → map Lead fields to Account/Contact/Opportunity fields under Setup → Fields & Relationships → Map Lead Fields (for custom fields).

INTERVIEW-READY ANSWER

"When a Lead is qualified, I convert it, which auto-creates the Account and Contact and optionally an Opportunity. I always double check custom field mapping under Lead Field Mapping in Setup so no custom data gets lost during conversion."

Opportunity Stages & Sales Path

DEFINITION

Opportunity Stages represent where a deal is in the sales process (Prospecting → Closed Won/Lost), each with a Probability %. Sales Path visually guides reps through stages with key fields and guidance for success at each step.

HOW TO IMPLEMENT (Setup steps)

Setup → Opportunity Stages to edit stages/probability; Setup → Path Settings → create a Sales Path per Record Type.

INTERVIEW-READY ANSWER

"I configure Opportunity Stages with realistic probabilities for accurate pipeline forecasting, and set up a Sales Path so reps see exactly which fields to fill and what guidance applies at each stage — it keeps the pipeline data clean."

Case Management, Assignment & Escalation Rules

DEFINITION

Case Assignment Rules auto-route new Cases to the right owner/queue based on criteria. Escalation Rules automatically escalate a Case (reassign, notify) if it isn't resolved within a set time.

HOW TO IMPLEMENT (Setup steps)

Setup → Case Assignment Rules / Escalation Rules → New Rule → define rule entries with criteria and assigned user/queue and time-based escalation criteria.

INTERVIEW-READY ANSWER

"I'd set up an Assignment Rule so, say, Cases with Priority = Critical route straight to the Tier-2 queue, and an Escalation Rule that reassigns and notifies a manager if a High priority case is still open after 4 business hours."

Queues, Omni-Channel & Console App

DEFINITION

Queue: a holding area for records (Cases, Leads) that a group of users can claim. Omni-Channel: routes work items (Cases, Chats) to the most available/skilled agent in real time. Service/Sales Console: a unified, tabbed, multi-pane workspace app for productivity.

HOW TO IMPLEMENT (Setup steps)

Setup → Queues → New (choose object, members). Setup → Omni-Channel → Routing Configuration + Presence Statuses. Setup → App Manager → New Lightning App → Console navigation.

INTERVIEW READY ANSWER

"For a support team, I'd route incoming Cases to a Queue by product line, and layer Omni-Channel on top so cases are pushed automatically to the next available agent based on their skill and current capacity — much faster than agents manually picking from a queue."

8. Deployment, Sandboxes & Change Management

Sandbox Types

DEFINITION

Developer: 200 MB storage, no data, config-only copy. Developer Pro: 1 GB, config-only, more storage. Partial Copy: sample of production data (up to 10,000 records per object via sandbox template) + config. Full Sandbox: complete copy of production, both data and config, largest and slowest to refresh.

HOW TO IMPLEMENT (Setup steps)

Setup → Sandboxes → New Sandbox → choose type, and (for Partial/Full) a sandbox template defining which data to copy.

INTERVIEW-READY ANSWER

"I use Developer sandboxes for quick individual configuration/testing, Partial Copy when I need realistic sample data for UAT, and a Full sandbox before a major release for final regression and load testing against real production-scale data."

Change Sets

DEFINITION

A native tool to migrate metadata (fields, flows, objects, layouts, etc. — not data) between connected orgs (e.g., Sandbox → Production) without third-party tools.

HOW TO IMPLEMENT (Setup steps)

Setup → Outbound Change Sets → New → add components → Upload → in target org, Setup → Inbound Change Sets → Validate/Deploy.

INTERVIEW-READY ANSWER

"For smaller, well-scoped releases I use Change Sets to move metadata from sandbox to production — I always validate first before deploying, and I keep a checklist of dependent components so nothing gets left behind."

Change Sets vs Other Deployment Tools

DEFINITION

Change Sets only work between orgs connected via a deployment connection (typically sandbox ↔ production of the same org) and don't support version control. For larger teams, tools like Salesforce CLI/DevOps Center/Git-based CI/CD (Copado, Gearset) give version control, automated testing, and rollback.

HOW TO IMPLEMENT (Setup steps)

N/A — awareness/comparison level for an Admin interview.

INTERVIEW-READY ANSWER

"Change Sets are fine for a small team doing simple releases, but they don't give you version control or a rollback path. For larger orgs I'd recommend a DevOps pipeline — Salesforce DevOps Center or Git-based CI/CD — even as an admin, I should understand this to work well with developers."

9. Extra Concepts Interviewers Often Probe

Chatter

DEFINITION

Salesforce's internal enterprise social collaboration tool — feed posts, @mentions, Groups, following records for real-time updates.

HOW TO IMPLEMENT (Setup steps)

Enabled by default in most orgs; Setup → Chatter Settings to configure.

INTERVIEW-READY ANSWER

"I use Chatter to keep teams aligned on records — for example, following a big Opportunity so everyone gets notified the moment the Stage changes, instead of relying on email."

AppExchange

DEFINITION

Salesforce's marketplace for pre-built apps, components, and consulting solutions that can be installed into an org to extend functionality without custom development.

HOW TO IMPLEMENT (Setup steps)

Setup → AppExchange Marketplace, or appexchange.salesforce.com → install a package into the org (test in sandbox first).

INTERVIEW-READY ANSWER

"Before building something custom, I always check AppExchange first — there's often a proven, supported package, like a mailing/DocuSign integration, that saves weeks of development."

Experience Cloud (Communities)

DEFINITION

Lets external users (customers, partners) access a branded portal built on Salesforce data, with its own licenses and sharing model.

HOW TO IMPLEMENT (Setup steps)

Setup → Digital Experiences → New Experience → choose template → configure pages, branding, and sharing/security via sharing sets or Experience Cloud user profiles.

INTERVIEW-READY ANSWER

"For a self-service customer portal where clients can log and track their own Cases, I'd build that on Experience Cloud, and control what they see through Sharing Sets scoped to just their own records."

Governor Limits (Admin awareness level)

DEFINITION

Salesforce enforces runtime limits (SOQL queries, DML statements, CPU time, etc.) per transaction to ensure fair resource use in the multi-tenant environment; mainly a developer concern, but admins must design automation to avoid hitting them (e.g., avoiding recursive Flows).

HOW TO IMPLEMENT (Setup steps)

N/A for admins directly, but relevant when designing multiple Record-Triggered Flows/automations on the same object.

INTERVIEW-READY ANSWER

"As an admin I won't write Apex governor-limit-safe code, but I'm careful not to stack too many Record-Triggered Flows and Workflow-era automations on the same object, since that can cause recursion or hit limits — I try to consolidate logic into one well-organized Flow per object where possible."

User Management & Licenses

DEFINITION

Every user needs a User License (Salesforce, Salesforce Platform, Chatter Free, etc. — determines base feature access) and a Profile; can add Permission Set Licenses for specific features (e.g., Sales Cloud Einstein).

HOW TO IMPLEMENT (Setup steps)

Setup → Users → New User → assign License, Profile, Role; deactivate (never hard-delete) users who leave.

INTERVIEW READY ANSWER

"When offboarding a user I never delete the record — I deactivate it, freeze it if immediate, reassign their open records via Mass Transfer, and reallocate their license so it can be reused."

10. General & Behavioral Interview Questions

Q. Tell me about yourself / your Salesforce experience.

Give a 60-90 second summary: current role, years on the platform, certifications (Admin/Advanced Admin/Platform App Builder), 2-3 concrete projects (e.g. 'redesigned the sharing model', 'migrated 15 Process Builders to Flow'), and end with why you're excited about this role.

Q. Walk me through how you'd set up security for a new custom object.

Structure the answer in order: 1) Decide OWD (start restrictive), 2) Build Role Hierarchy access if needed, 3) Add Sharing Rules for horizontal access, 4) Set object/field permissions on Profiles, 5) Layer Permission Sets for exceptions, 6) Configure Page Layouts & Record Types last.

Q. A user says they can't see a record they should see — how do you troubleshoot?

Use Salesforce's 'Sharing' related list / 'Why can I see this?' tool. Check in order: OWD → Role Hierarchy → Sharing Rules → Manual Share → Team/Account access → Profile object permission ('Read') → check if it's actually a Field-Level-Security issue instead of a record-visibility issue.

Q. Workflow Rule vs Process Builder vs Flow — which do you use and why?

Be honest: Workflow Rules and Process Builder are legacy/retired for new builds. State you build all new automation in Flow (Record-Triggered for backend logic, Screen Flow for guided user input) and that you'd proactively migrate old automations using Salesforce's Migrate to Flow tool.

Q. How do you handle a large data migration into Salesforce?

Mention: plan field mapping and data cleansing first, use a sandbox to test load, use Data Loader with an External ID field for upsert to avoid duplicates, load parent records before children (respect relationships), validate with a sample batch before the full load, and take a backup/export before big changes.

Q. How do you stay updated with new Salesforce features?

Trailhead, Salesforce Release Notes (three releases/year), Salesforce Admins blog/podcast, Trailblazer Community, and testing new features in a sandbox before every release window.

Q. Describe a time you improved a process using Salesforce automation.

Use the STAR method (Situation, Task, Action, Result) with a specific, quantifiable outcome — e.g. 'reduced manual case routing time by building an Omni-Channel + Assignment Rule setup, cutting response time by 40%.'

11. Final Tips Before You Walk In

- Always answer with the STRUCTURE first (definition), then IMPLEMENTATION (how you'd actually build it in Setup), then a real or plausible EXAMPLE — interviewers reward this pattern.
- If you don't know something, say so honestly and explain how you'd find out (Trailhead, Salesforce Help, Trailblazer Community) — admins are expected to know how to research, not memorize everything.
- Keep a couple of specific numbers ready from your own experience (e.g., '200 users', '3 sandboxes', '15 automations migrated to Flow') — specificity signals real hands-on experience.
- Mention Flow explicitly wherever Workflow Rules/Process Builder could be the 'expected' textbook answer — it shows you're current with Salesforce's roadmap.
- For scenario questions, always start your answer with 'First, I'd check...' — it shows a diagnostic, structured mindset rather than guessing.

All the best for your Salesforce Admin interview — you've got this! ■